

Women's Fitness Guide

Strength Training Benefits

Resistance training supports bone density, which is particularly relevant given a higher lifetime risk of osteoporosis in women, especially post-menopause.

Contrary to a common myth, resistance training does not typically produce large, bulky muscle gains in women due to comparatively lower testosterone levels - it instead supports a toned, strong physique.

Training Around the Menstrual Cycle

Some individuals notice higher energy and strength performance in the follicular phase (after menstruation, before ovulation) and prefer to schedule higher-intensity sessions then.

During menstruation, symptoms vary widely - some continue normal training, others prefer lighter sessions; both are reasonable depending on how one feels.

This is general information, not individual medical guidance - those with heavy symptoms or conditions like PCOS or endometriosis should consult a healthcare provider for personalized advice.

Nutrition Considerations

Iron needs are generally higher due to menstrual blood loss; iron-rich foods (lean meat, legumes, leafy greens) or supplementation (if deficient, per a healthcare provider) can help.

Calcium and Vitamin D intake supports long-term bone health alongside resistance training.

Pregnancy & Postpartum (General Notes)

Exercise during pregnancy is generally encouraged for those with uncomplicated pregnancies, but programming should be adjusted (e.g., avoiding supine positions in later trimesters, avoiding contact/fall risk) under guidance from an obstetrician.

Postpartum return to training should be gradual and cleared by a healthcare provider, often starting with pelvic floor and core rehabilitation before general resistance training resumes.